

7 Things to Do with Inexpensive Wine

Want to add a little class to your meal? It doesn't have to cost a fortune to add a little wine to your recipes. Pick up some inexpensive Charles Shaw or boxed wine and you're well on your way to adding a little bit of elegance to your table without breaking the bank.

1. Mulled wine

I love strolling through the Christmas markets in Europe and drinking this stuff. It smells oh so fabulous and tastes yummy. Since it's mixed with so many other items, it's kind of expected that you won't use an expensive wine anyway. Either whites or reds can be used, and a simple Internet search can snag you a huge selection of affordable recipes.

2. Fruit salad glaze

Instead of using whipped topping or mixing up gelatin, whisk honey

with white or red wine until it makes a bit of a glaze and add ground cinnamon to taste. Toss fresh chopped fruit like apples, grapes, or peaches with perhaps a few chopped walnuts and then coat with the glaze. This is a nice light after-meal treat with a fair amount of punch.

3. Sangria

As with mulled wine, using the cheap stuff is expected. You can make sangria with either red or white wine; add fruit juice and some sliced fruit. A sparkling sangria is also achievable by simply adding a bit of seltzer.

4. Marinades

I'm sure there are a ton of recipes out there for this, but a simple cheap one that I've gotten lots of compliments on uses just plain boxed white wine, honey, and rosemary. You can whisk this up to your own desired consistency. It's really great with chicken breasts.

5. Salad dressings

Whisking reduced red wine with olive oil, salt, pepper, and Dijon mustard makes an elegant salad dressing.

